Past Continuous

Interrupted Actions — الماضي البسيط مع when / while

Level 2 — with Past Simple

Name: _____ Date: _____

1 Definition · التعريف

حدثٌ طويل كان جاريًا (ماضٍ مستمر) يقطعه حدثٌ قصير وقع فجأة (ماضٍ بسيط).

A longer action in progress (past continuous) is interrupted by a shorter action (past simple).

was / were + V-ing + when + past simple

2 Key Facts · حقائق أساسية

★ الحدث الطويل الجاري ← ماضٍ مستمر · الحدث القصير المقاطع ← ماضٍ بسيط.

Long background action = past continuous; short interrupting action = past simple.

★ when + ماضٍ بسيط (الحدث القصير) · while + ماضٍ مستمر (الحدث الطويل).

when + past simple (short action); while + past continuous (long action).

★ حدثان طويلان معًا: While I was cooking, he was cleaning.

Two long actions together: use while + past continuous for both.

★ إذا بدأت الجملة بـ When/While نضع فاصلة بعد العبارة.

When the sentence starts with When/While, put a comma after that clause.

while + past continuous	when + past simple
While I was reading, the phone rang.	When the phone rang, I was reading.
It happened while I was sleeping.	I was sleeping when it happened.

3 Steps · خطوات النجاح

الخلفية الطويلة ← was/were + V-ing . المقاطعة القصيرة ← past simple . اربط/ي بـ when/while.

Long background → was/were + V-ing. Short interruption → past simple. Join with when/while.

مقاطعة

I was sleeping when the alarm rang.

while

While we were walking, it started to rain.

حدثان طويلان

While my mother was cooking, I was helping her.

4 Summary · الخلاصة

✦ تذكّر/ي دائمًا · Remember

while + جارٍ طويل · when + حدث قصير · فاصلة إذا بدأت الجملة بالعبارة.

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Let's Practice!

1 Recognize · تعرّف

Choose the past continuous or the past simple.
اختر/ي الماضي المستمر أو الماضي البسيط.

1. While I _____ , I saw a friend. (was walking / walked)
2. When the teacher _____ in, we were talking. (was coming / came)
3. They were playing when it _____ to rain. (was starting / started)
4. While she _____ , the phone rang. (was cooking / cooked)

2 Multiple Choice · اختيار من متعدد

Choose when or while.
اختر/ي when أو while.

1. _____ I was reading, the lights went out. a) When b) While
2. I was sleeping _____ the earthquake happened. a) when b) while
3. _____ the bell rang, we were leaving class. a) When b) While

3 Fill in · إكمال الفراغ

Use the past continuous for the long action and the past simple for the short one.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر للحدث الطويل والبسيط للقصير.

1. While we _____ (have) lunch, the guests _____ (arrive).
2. I _____ (watch) TV when the power _____ (go) off.
3. When you called, I _____ (study) in my room.
4. While the baby _____ (sleep), my mother _____ (cook).

4 Match · توصيل

Match each clause with its ending — write the letter.
صِل/ي كل بداية بنهايتها — اكتب/ي الحرف.

1) While I was studying,	____	a) we were playing outside.
2) When the rain started,	____	b) when I fell down.
3) I was riding my bike	____	c) my brother was watching TV.

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Keep Going!

5 Transform · تحويل

Join the two sentences with when or while.
اربط/ي الجملتين بـ when أو while.

1. I was cooking. The phone rang. → .....

2. We were walking. It started to rain. → .....

6 Correct · تصحيح خطأ

Each sentence has one mistake. Correct it.
في كل جملة خطأ واحد. صحّح/يه.

1. I was read when she called. → .....

2. While they played, it started to snow. → .....

3. When I was cooking, I was cutting my finger. → .....

7 In Context · توظيف سياقي

Use the past continuous or the past simple for each verb.
استخدم/ي الماضي المستمر أو البسيط لكل فعل.

It was a quiet afternoon in Jaffa. While my grandfather (1) _____ (tell) us a story, the electricity suddenly (2) _____ (go) off. We (3) _____ (sit) in the dark when my mother (4) _____ (bring) a lamp. While she (5) _____ (light) it, we all (6) _____ (laugh).

8 Create · تحدٍ إبداعي

Write one sentence with when and one with while about yesterday.
اكتب/ي جملة بـ when وأخرى بـ while عن أمس.

.....

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Answer Key

🔑 Answer Key · مفتاح الإجابات للمعلمة

تمرين ١: was walking · came · started · was cooking

تمرين ٢: b) While · a) when · a) When

تمرين ٣: were having / arrived · was watching / went · was studying · was sleeping / was cooking

تمرين ٤: 1 → c · 2 → a · 3 → b

تمرين ٥: I was cooking when the phone rang. · While we were walking, it started to rain.

تمرين ٦: I was reading when she called. · While they were playing, it started to snow. · When I was cooking, I cut my finger.

تمرين ٧: 1 was telling · 2 went · 3 were sitting · 4 brought · 5 was lighting · 6 laughed

تمرين ٨: إجابات مفتوحة! (when + ماضٍ بسيط · while + ماضٍ مستمر).

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